

Leheng Zhang

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[Personal Homepage](#) [Google Scholar](#) [GitHub](#)



EDUCATION

South China Normal University
Computer Science and Technology (Junior)

Guangzhou, Guangdong
Sep. 2023–Present

- ▷ GPA: 4.02/5.0.
- ▷ Major rank: 2/153 (top 1.3%).
- ▷ Ranked 2nd in the comprehensive assessment in the freshman year and 1st in the sophomore year.
- ▷ English proficiency: CET-4: 647; CET-6: 571; IELTS: 7.0.
- ▷ Honors: First-Class Outstanding Student Scholarship for Full-Time Undergraduates, School of Computer Science, South China Normal University (2023–2024 and 2024–2025); Second Prize, Undergraduate Student Innovation Award, South China Normal University (2024).

University of British Columbia
International Visiting Student

Vancouver, Canada
Jul. 2024–Aug. 2024

- ▷ Course 1: “Music: An introduction to Electrical & Computer Engineering.”
- ▷ Course 2: “Music Laboratory: Hands on Learning.”

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Targeted Drug Research for Epstein–Barr Virus

Jul. 2025

- ▷ Advisor: Prof. Sijie Mai, South China Normal University (in collaboration with Academician Musheng Zeng’s team at Sun Yat-sen University Cancer Center).
- ▷ Used diffusion models to develop targeted drugs against the DBD or other regions of the EBNA1 protein.

Multimodal Computing

Jul. 2025

- ▷ Advisor: Prof. Sijie Mai, South China Normal University.
- ▷ Used pretrained language models and multimodal large language models for multimodal sentiment analysis.
- ▷ 1 paper accepted at ACM Multimedia, 1 at Interspeech (Oral), 1 first-author paper submitted to Information Fusion, 1 first-author paper submitted to EMNLP, and 1 paper submitted to AAAI.
- GRCF: Group-wise Ranking and Calibration Framework for Multimodal Sentiment Analysis. Inspired by group-relative advantage weighting in GRPO, it introduces adaptive hard-sample weighting, dynamic margins, and two-stage ranking calibration; accepted at ACM Multimedia 2026, second author.
- PRISM: Primary-Centric Multimodal Fusion with Information Bottlenecks and Confidence-Aware Gating. It proposes a primary-modality-driven dynamic fusion framework combining variational token bottlenecks, sample-level differentiable primary-modality routing, and confidence-aware gating; submitted to Information Fusion, first author.
- Uncovering Latent Depression Severity for Binary Depression Detection via Advantage-weighting Ranking. It introduces the BAR loss to recover the latent ordinal structure of depression severity and improve hard-sample discrimination; accepted at Interspeech 2026 (Oral), third author.
- RITHM: Recursive Information-Theoretic Halting for Multimodal Sentiment Understanding. It combines recursive information bottlenecks, information-gain-based halting, and syntax-aware composition for sample-adaptive reasoning; submitted to EMNLP 2026, first author.
- Deconfounding Multimodal Affective Computing via Minimal Global Causal Representations. It proposes CaMIB, which disentangles causal and confounding representations through information bottlenecks, causal intervention, and instrumental-variable constraints to improve OOD generalization under distribution shifts; submitted to AAAI 2027, second author.

COMPETITION EXPERIENCE

National College Student Computer System Capability Competition—OS Design Contest (South China Region) Jan. 2026

- ▷ Independently developed a tool for detecting security vulnerabilities in Linux kernel code and won First Prize.

PROJECT EXPERIENCE

Embodied-AI Robotic Arm for Playing Board Games

Dec. 2024

- ▷ Advisor: Prof. Sijie Mai, South China Normal University.
- ▷ Debugged the robotic arm, fine-tuned large language models, studied robotic-arm control, and used the arm to play Gomoku and Go.
- ▷ Developed an LLM-driven board-game-playing robotic arm; the related software was granted computer software copy-right registration.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Research interests: Multimodal computing, embodied intelligence, and AI for Science.

Plan to pursue doctoral studies.